

Deep Generative Models

Lecture 11

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AI Masters

2026, Spring

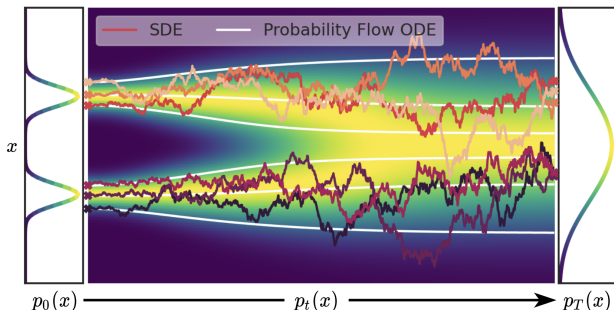
Recap of Previous Lecture

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w} \quad (\text{SDE with the probability path } p_t(\mathbf{x}))$$

Probability Flow ODE

There exists an ODE with the identical probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ of the form:

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt, \quad \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$



Song Y., et al. *Score-Based Generative Modeling through Stochastic Differential Equations*, 2020

Recap of Previous Lecture

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt, \quad \mathbf{x}(t + dt) = \mathbf{x}(t) + \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt$$

Reverse ODE

Let $\tau = 1 - t$ ($d\tau = -dt$):

$$d\mathbf{x} = -\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, 1 - \tau)d\tau$$

Reverse SDE

There's a reverse SDE for $d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$ in the following form:

$$d\mathbf{x} = \left(\mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - g^2(t) \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x}) \right) dt + g(t)d\bar{\mathbf{w}}, \quad dt < 0$$

Sketch of the Proof

- ▶ Convert the initial SDE to the probability flow ODE.
- ▶ Reverse the probability flow ODE.
- ▶ Convert the reverse probability flow ODE to the reverse SDE.

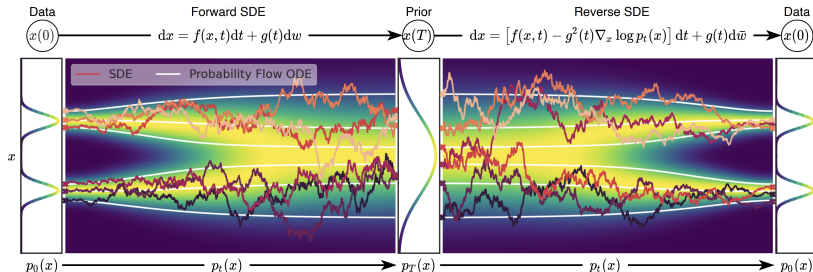
Recap of Previous Lecture

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt + g(t)d\mathbf{w}$$

$$\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \mathbf{f}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\mathbf{s}(\mathbf{x}, t), \quad \text{where} \quad \mathbf{s}(\mathbf{x}, t) = \nabla_{\mathbf{x}} \log p_t(\mathbf{x})$$

$$d\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)dt \quad - \text{Probability Flow ODE}$$

$$d\mathbf{x} = \left(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \frac{1}{2}g^2(t)\mathbf{s}(\mathbf{x}, t)\right)dt + g(t)d\bar{\mathbf{w}} \quad - \text{Reverse SDE}$$



Song Y., et al. *Score-Based Generative Modeling through Stochastic Differential Equations*, 2020

Recap of Previous Lecture

Discrete-Time Objective

$$\mathbb{E}_{p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x}_0)} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U\{1, T\}} \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0)} \left\| \mathbf{s}_{\theta, t}(\mathbf{x}_t) - \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_t} \log q(\mathbf{x}_t | \mathbf{x}_0) \right\|_2^2$$

Continuous-Time Objective

$$\mathbb{E}_{p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x}(0))} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0, 1]} \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{x}(0))} \left\| \mathbf{s}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}(t), t) - \nabla_{\mathbf{x}(t)} \log q(\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{x}(0)) \right\|_2^2$$

NCSN

$$q(\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{x}(0)) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{x}(0), [\sigma^2(t) - \sigma^2(0)] \cdot \mathbf{I})$$

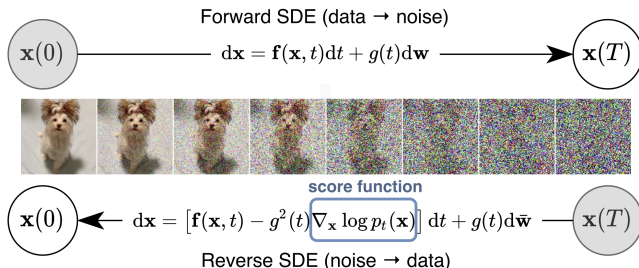
DDPM

$$q(\mathbf{x}(t) | \mathbf{x}(0)) = \mathcal{N}\left(\mathbf{x}(0) e^{-\frac{1}{2} \int_0^t \beta(s) ds}, \left(1 - e^{-\int_0^t \beta(s) ds}\right) \cdot \mathbf{I}\right)$$

Recap of Previous Lecture

Sampling

To sample, solve the reverse SDE using numerical solvers (SDEsolve).



- ▶ Discretizing the reverse SDE gives us ancestral sampling.
- ▶ If we use the probability flow ODE instead, then the reverse ODE yields DDIM sampling.

Recap of Previous Lecture

Consider ODE dynamics $\mathbf{x}(t)$ in the interval $t \in [0, 1]$ with $\mathbf{x}_0 \sim p_0(\mathbf{x}) = \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$, $\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_1(\mathbf{x}) = p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})$.

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}}{dt} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t), \quad \text{with initial condition } \mathbf{x}(0) = \mathbf{x}_0.$$

KFP Theorem (Continuity Equation)

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = -\text{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})) \Leftrightarrow \frac{d \log p_t(\mathbf{x}(t))}{dt} = -\text{tr} \left(\frac{\partial \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}(t), t)}{\partial \mathbf{x}(t)} \right)$$

Solving the continuity equation ODE numerically is complicated and unstable.

Flow Matching

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Flow matching is a scalable approach to Neural ODEs.

Outline

1. Conditional Flow Matching
2. One-Sided Conditioning
3. Two-Sided Conditioning

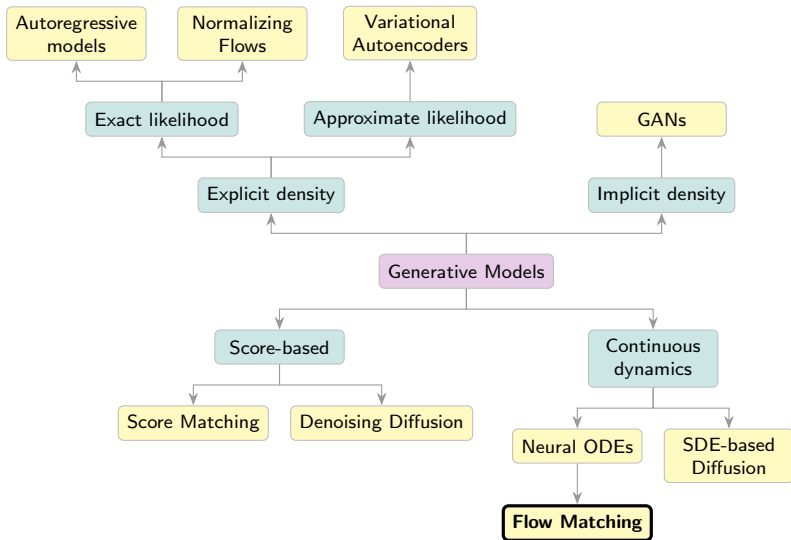
Outline

1. Conditional Flow Matching

2. One-Sided Conditioning

3. Two-Sided Conditioning

Generative Models Taxonomy



Flow Matching

Let's introduce the latent variable $\mathbf{z}$:

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z}$$

Here, $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$ is a **conditional probability path**.

Flow Matching

Let's introduce the latent variable $\mathbf{z}$:

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z}$$

Here, $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$ is a **conditional probability path**. The conditional probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$ satisfies the KFP theorem:

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})}{\partial t} = -\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})),$$

where $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)$ is a **conditional vector field**:

Flow Matching

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where $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)$ is a **conditional vector field**:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}_t}{dt} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, t) \quad \Rightarrow \quad \frac{d\mathbf{x}_t}{dt} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{z}, t)$$

Flow Matching

Flow Matching (FM)

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Conditional Flow Matching (CFM)

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Flow Matching

Flow Matching (FM)

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$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Theorem

If $\text{supp}(p_t(\mathbf{x})) = \mathbb{R}^m$, then the optimal value of the FM objective equals the optimal value of the CFM objective.

Flow Matching

Flow Matching (FM)

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Conditional Flow Matching (CFM)

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Theorem

If $\text{supp}(p_t(\mathbf{x})) = \mathbb{R}^m$, then the optimal value of the FM objective equals the optimal value of the CFM objective.

Proof

This can be proved in a similar way as in the denoising score matching theorem.

Conditional Flow Matching

Theorem

$$\begin{aligned} \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 &= \\ = \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

Conditional Flow Matching

Theorem

$$\begin{aligned} \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 &= \\ = \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

Proof

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 &= \\ = \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} [\|\mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 - 2\mathbf{v}_{\theta}^{\top}(\mathbf{x}, t)\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)] + \text{const}(\theta) \end{aligned}$$

Conditional Flow Matching

Theorem

$$\begin{aligned} \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 &= \\ = \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

Proof

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Conditional Flow Matching

Theorem

$$\begin{aligned} \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 &= \\ = \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

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Conditional Flow Matching

Theorem

$$\begin{aligned} \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 &= \\ = \arg \min_{\theta} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

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Conditional Flow Matching: Training and Sampling

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

$$\mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z})} p_0(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I}); \quad \mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z})} p_1(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x}).$$

Conditional Flow Matching: Training and Sampling

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

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Training

1. Sample a time $t \sim U[0, 1]$ and $\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})$.
2. Draw $\mathbf{x}_t \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$.
3. Compute the loss $\mathcal{L} = \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}_t, t)\|^2$.

Conditional Flow Matching: Training and Sampling

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

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Sampling

1. Sample $\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$.
2. Solve the ODE to obtain $\mathbf{x}_1$:

$$\mathbf{x}_1 = \psi_1(\mathbf{x}_0) = \text{ODESolve}_v(\mathbf{x}_0, \theta, t_0 = 0, t_1 = 1).$$

Conditional Vector Field

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})}{\partial t} = -\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})),$$

What's the relationship between $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)$ and $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)$?

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Theorem

The following vector field generates the probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$:

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Proof

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z}$$

Conditional Vector Field

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Proof

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Conditional Vector Field

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Conditional Vector Field

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Proof

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z} = \int \left(\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})}{\partial t} \right) p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z} = \\ &= \int (-\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}))) p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z} = \\ &= -\operatorname{div} \left(\int \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z} \right) = -\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x}))\end{aligned}$$

Marginal-to-Conditional: Scores vs Velocities

Denoising Score Matching

$$\mathbb{E}_{p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x}_\sigma | \mathbf{x})} \|\mathbf{s}_{\theta, \sigma}(\mathbf{x}_\sigma) - \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_\sigma} \log q(\mathbf{x}_\sigma | \mathbf{x})\|_2^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Optimal predictor:

$$\mathbf{s}_{\theta^*, \sigma}(\mathbf{x}_\sigma) = \mathbb{E}_{q(\mathbf{x} | \mathbf{x}_\sigma)} [\nabla_{\mathbf{x}_\sigma} \log q(\mathbf{x}_\sigma | \mathbf{x})] = \nabla_{\mathbf{x}_\sigma} \log q(\mathbf{x}_\sigma)$$

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Conditional Flow Matching

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

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In both cases, the optimal MSE predictor is the posterior mean of the **conditional** target, which equals the intractable **marginal** quantity (score or velocity).

Conditional Flow Matching: Continuity Equations

Continuity Equations

$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x})}{\partial t} = -\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t) \cdot p_t(\mathbf{x}))$$
$$\frac{\partial p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})}{\partial t} = -\operatorname{div}(\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) \cdot p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}))$$

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- ▶ But the reverse is not true: any divergence-free vector field $\operatorname{div}(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})) = 0$ can generate a valid probability path.

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- ▶ But the reverse is not true: any divergence-free vector field $\operatorname{div}(\tilde{\mathbf{v}}(\mathbf{x}, t)p_t(\mathbf{x})) = 0$ can generate a valid probability path.
- ▶ Moreover, not every given path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ can actually arise from particles moving under some velocity field $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)$.

Conditional Flow Matching: Paths and Vector Fields

Probability Paths

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z}$$

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Conditional Flow Matching: Paths and Vector Fields

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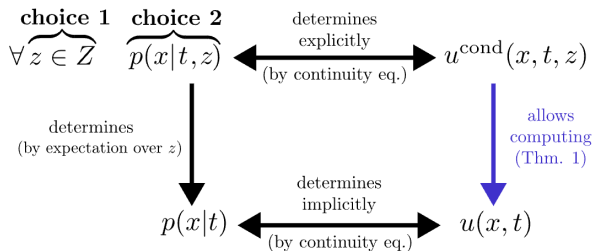
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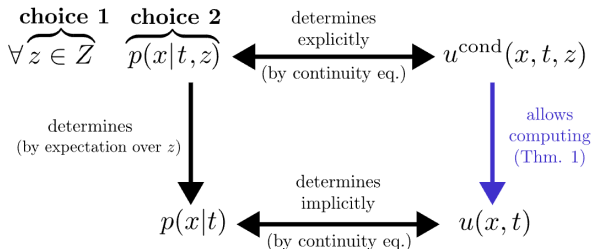
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- ▶ $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t)$ and $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$ uniquely determine $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, t)$.
- ▶ But marginal velocity does not determine conditional velocities (many decompositions exist).

From Marginal to Conditional Paths



From Marginal to Conditional Paths



Open Questions

- Q1** How should we choose the convenient conditioning latent variable $\mathbf{z}$?
- Q2** How can we parametrize $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ (or $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$) to enforce the following constraints?

$$\mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z})} p_0(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I}); \quad \mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z})} p_1(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x}).$$

Gaussian Conditional Probability Paths [Q2]

Let's consider the following parametrization:

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{z}), \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t^2(\mathbf{z}))$$

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The concrete $\boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{z})$, $\boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{z})$ (which satisfies the boundary constraints) will be fixed once we choose $\mathbf{z}$ [Q1].

Gaussian flow

- ▶ Let's derive the vector field for **any** Gaussian path $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$.
- ▶ There are infinitely many flows $\psi_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{z})$ (or, equivalently, vector fields $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{z}, t)$) that generate a particular probability path $p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})$.

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- ▶ Let's consider the following flow:

$$\mathbf{x}_t = \boldsymbol{\psi}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{z}) = \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{z}) + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{z}) \odot \boldsymbol{\epsilon},$$

where $\boldsymbol{\epsilon}$ is fixed by the condition: $\mathbf{x}_0 = \boldsymbol{\mu}_0(\mathbf{z}) + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_0(\mathbf{z}) \odot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$.

Gaussian Conditional Vector Field

Gaussian Conditional Probability Path

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{z}), \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t^2(\mathbf{z})) ; \quad \mathbf{x}_t = \psi_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{z}) = \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{z}) + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{z}) \odot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$$

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Outline

1. Conditional Flow Matching
2. One-Sided Conditioning
3. Two-Sided Conditioning

Endpoint Conditioning

Conditional Flow Matching

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Let define our latent variable $\mathbf{z}$.

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Conditioning Latent Variable [Q1]

Let us choose $\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{x}_1$. Then $p(\mathbf{z}) = p_1(\mathbf{x}_1)$.

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1) p_1(\mathbf{x}_1) d\mathbf{x}_1$$

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$$p_0(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I}); \quad p_1(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1) = \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_1)$$

Gaussian Conditional Probability Path

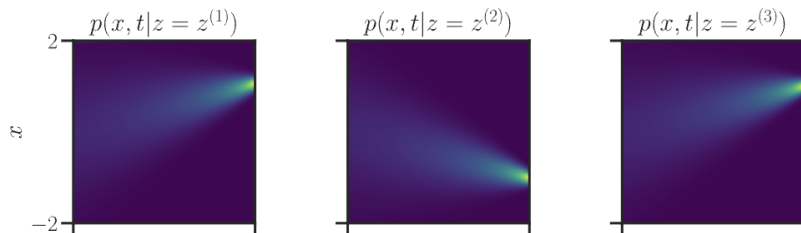
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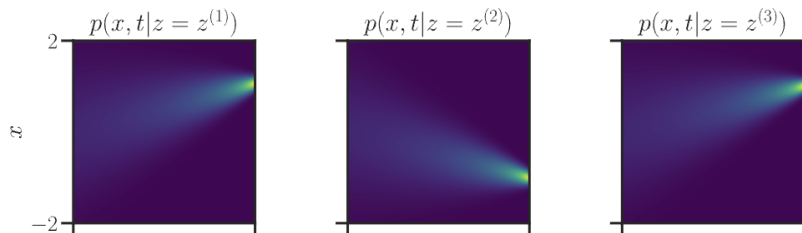


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Let's consider straight conditional paths:

$$\begin{cases} \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_1) = t\mathbf{x}_1 \\ \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{x}_1) = 1 - t \end{cases}$$

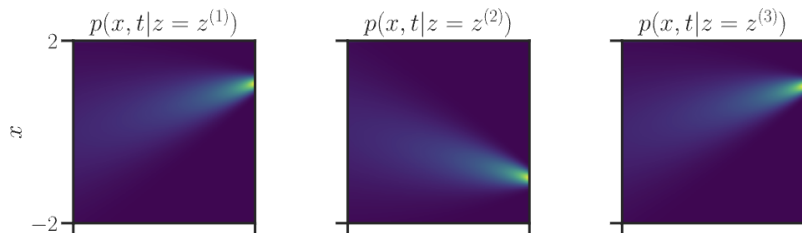
image credit: *A Visual Dive into Conditional Flow Matching*

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image credit: A Visual Dive into Conditional Flow Matching

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Conditional Vector Field

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}_t}{dt} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_1, t) = \mu'_t(\mathbf{x}_1) + \frac{\sigma'_t(\mathbf{x}_1)}{\sigma_t(\mathbf{x}_1)} \odot (\mathbf{x}_t - \mu_t(\mathbf{x}_1))$$

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$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_1, t) &= \mathbf{x}_1 - \frac{1}{1-t} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_t - t\mathbf{x}_1) = \frac{\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_t}{1-t} = \\ &= \frac{\mathbf{x}_1 - t\mathbf{x}_1 - (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0}{1-t} = \mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0 \end{aligned}$$

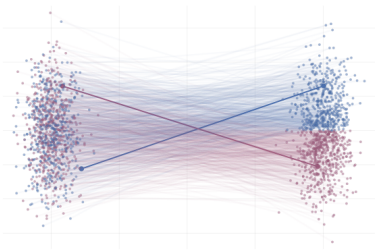
One-Sided Conditioning: Conditional Vector Field

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(t\mathbf{x}_1, (1-t)^2\mathbf{I}); \quad \mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

Conditional Vector Field

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}_t}{dt} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_1, t) = \mu'_t(\mathbf{x}_1) + \frac{\sigma'_t(\mathbf{x}_1)}{\sigma_t(\mathbf{x}_1)} \odot (\mathbf{x}_t - \mu_t(\mathbf{x}_1))$$

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The conditional vector field $\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_1, t)$ defines straight lines between $p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})$ and $\mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$.

One-Sided Conditioning: CFM Objective

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 = \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1)} \left\| \frac{\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}}{1 - t} - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t) \right\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

One-Sided Conditioning: CFM Objective

$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 = \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1)} \left\| \frac{\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}}{1 - t} - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t) \right\|^2 = \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \mathbf{I})} \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

One-Sided Conditioning: CFM Objective

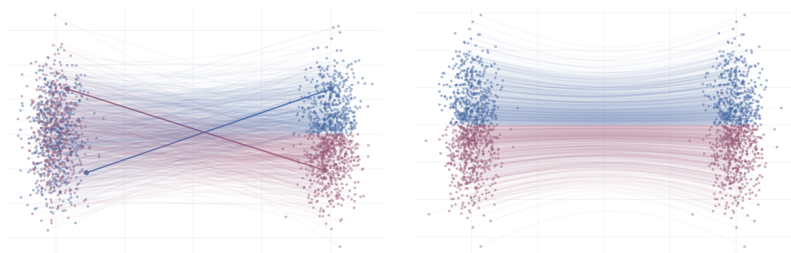
$$\begin{aligned} & \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 = \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1)} \left\| \frac{\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}}{1 - t} - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t) \right\|^2 = \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \mathbf{I})} \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

- ▶ We fit straight lines between the noise distribution $p(\mathbf{x})$ and the data distribution $p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})$.
- ▶ The **marginal** path $p_t(\mathbf{x})$ does not give straight lines.

One-Sided Conditioning: CFM Objective

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CFM with One-Sided Conditioning: Training and Sampling

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})} \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Training

1. Sample $\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})$.
2. Sample time $t \sim U[0, 1]$ and $\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$.
3. Obtain the noisy image $\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0$.
4. Compute the loss $\mathcal{L} = \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t, t)\|^2$.

CFM with One-Sided Conditioning: Training and Sampling

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})} \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_t, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Training

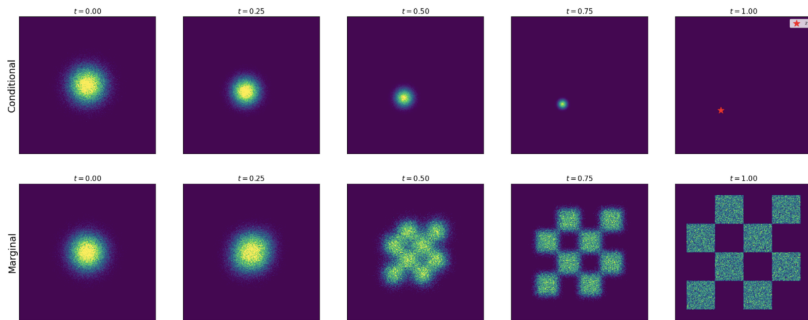
1. Sample $\mathbf{x}_1 \sim p_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})$.
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Sampling

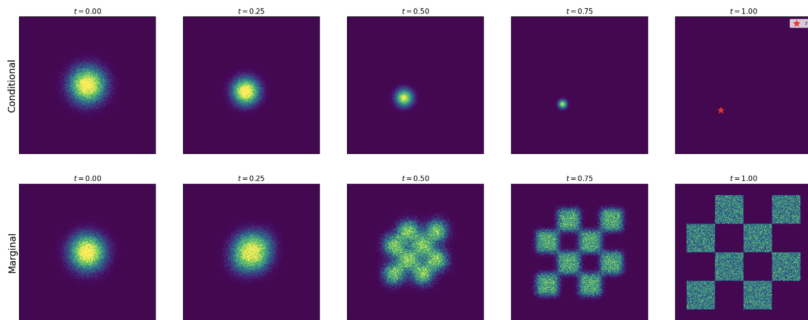
1. Sample $\mathbf{x}_0 \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$.
2. Solve the ODE to obtain $\mathbf{x}_1$:

$$\mathbf{x}_1 = \psi_1(\mathbf{x}_0) = \text{ODESolve}_v(\mathbf{x}_0, \theta, t_0 = 0, t_1 = 1)$$

Conditional vs. Marginal Paths



Conditional vs. Marginal Paths



- ▶ One-sided conditioning gives us the way to construct generative model.
- ▶ Now we extend it to image-to-image formulation (mapping between two distinct $p_{\text{data}_1}(\mathbf{x})$ and $p_{\text{data}_2}(\mathbf{x})$).

Outline

1. Conditional Flow Matching
2. One-Sided Conditioning
3. Two-Sided Conditioning

Pair Conditioning

Conditional Flow Matching

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

Conditioning Latent Variable [Q1]

Let us choose $\mathbf{z} = (\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)$. Then $p(\mathbf{z}) = p(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = p_0(\mathbf{x}_0)p_1(\mathbf{x}_1)$.

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}) = \int p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) p_0(\mathbf{x}_0) p_1(\mathbf{x}_1) d\mathbf{x}_0 d\mathbf{x}_1$$

Pair Conditioning

Conditional Flow Matching

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We must enforce boundary constraints:

$$\begin{cases} p_0(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z})} p_0(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}); \\ p_1(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z})} p_1(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z}) \end{cases}$$

Pair Conditioning

Conditional Flow Matching

$$\mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \rightarrow \min_{\theta}$$

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Two-Sided Conditioning

$$p_0(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_0); \quad p_1(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_1)$$

Gaussian Conditional Probability Path

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1), \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t^2(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)); \quad \mathbf{x}_t = \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) \odot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$$

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Let's consider straight conditional paths:

$$\begin{cases} \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0 \\ \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \epsilon \end{cases}$$

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Two-Sided Conditioning

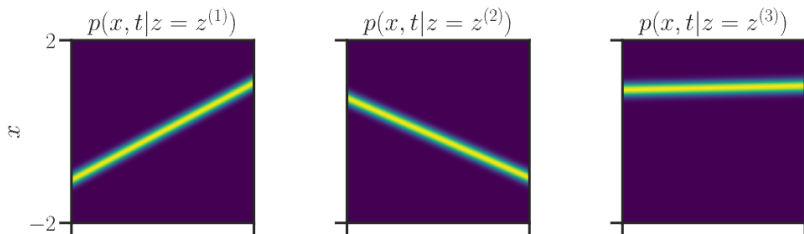
$$p_0(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_0); \quad p_1(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \delta(\mathbf{x} - \mathbf{x}_1)$$

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$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1), \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t^2(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)); \quad \mathbf{x}_t = \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) + \boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) \odot \boldsymbol{\epsilon}$$

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Flow Matching: One-Sided vs. Two-Sided Conditioning

$$\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{x}_1$$

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(t\mathbf{x}_1, (1-t)^2\mathbf{I})$$

$$\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

$$\mathbf{z} = (\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)$$

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0, \epsilon^2\mathbf{I})$$

$$\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

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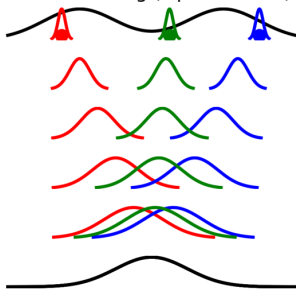
$$\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

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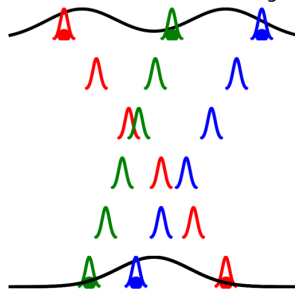
$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0, \epsilon^2\mathbf{I})$$

$$\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

Flow Matching (Lipman et al.)



Conditional Flow Matching



Two-Sided Conditioning: Vector Field and Objective

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N}(t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0, \epsilon^2 \mathbf{I}); \quad \mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1-t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

Conditional Vector Field

$$\frac{d\mathbf{x}_t}{dt} = \mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}_t, \mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1, t) = \boldsymbol{\mu}'_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) + \frac{\boldsymbol{\sigma}'_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)}{\boldsymbol{\sigma}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)} \odot (\mathbf{x}_t - \boldsymbol{\mu}_t(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1))$$

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Two-Sided Conditioning: Vector Field and Objective

$$p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) = \mathcal{N} \left(t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0, \epsilon^2 \mathbf{I} \right); \quad \mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0$$

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Conditional Flow Matching

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{z} \sim p(\mathbf{z})} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})} \|\mathbf{v}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{z}, t) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 = \\ \mathbb{E}_{t \sim U[0,1]} \mathbb{E}_{(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) \sim p(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)} \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{x} \sim p_t(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)} \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}, t)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

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Conditional Flow Matching

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- ▶ This yields the same procedure as for one-sided conditioning!
- ▶ Now, we do not require that $p_0(\mathbf{x})$ is necessarily $\mathcal{N}(0, \mathbf{I})$.

CFM with Two-Sided Conditioning: Training and Sampling

- ▶ This conditioning allows us to transport any distribution $p_0(\mathbf{x})$ to any distribution $p_1(\mathbf{x})$.
- ▶ It's possible to apply this approach to paired tasks, e.g., style transfer.

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Training Procedure

1. Sample $(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1) \sim p(\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)$.
2. Sample time $t \sim U[0, 1]$.
3. Compute the noisy image $\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0$.
4. Compute the loss $\mathcal{L} = \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}_t, t)\|^2$.

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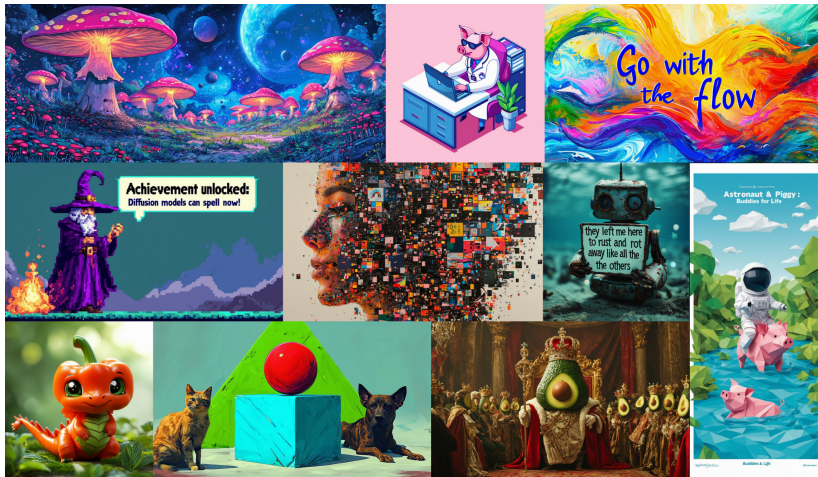
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2. Sample time $t \sim U[0, 1]$.
3. Compute the noisy image $\mathbf{x}_t = t\mathbf{x}_1 + (1 - t)\mathbf{x}_0$.
4. Compute the loss $\mathcal{L} = \|(\mathbf{x}_1 - \mathbf{x}_0) - \mathbf{v}_\theta(\mathbf{x}_t, t)\|^2$.

Sampling

1. Sample $\mathbf{x}_0 \sim p_0(\mathbf{x})$.
2. Solve the ODE to obtain $\mathbf{x}_1$:

$$\mathbf{x}_1 = \psi_1(\mathbf{x}_0) = \text{ODESolve}_v(\mathbf{x}_0, \boldsymbol{\theta}, t_0 = 0, t_1 = 1)$$

Stable Diffusion 3: Scalable Flow Matching



Esser P., et al. *Scaling Rectified Flow Transformers for High-Resolution Image Synthesis*, 2024

Summary

- ▶ Conditional flow matching introduces the latent variable $\mathbf{z}$, reformulating the initial task in terms of conditional dynamics.
- ▶ Conditional flow matching makes the FM objective tractable.
- ▶ One-sided conditioning uses endpoint conditioning $\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{x}_1$ and serves as an effective FM technique.
- ▶ Two-sided conditioning uses pair conditioning $\mathbf{z} = (\mathbf{x}_0, \mathbf{x}_1)$ and yields the same procedure, but is more general (suitable for paired tasks).